

The Eighth Wonder

May. You too have undoubtedly felt its wrath—especially in the sun-beating-down-on-hapless-soul department. This is also the month that we stock up on coffee (and all the accessories, of course—sugar, milk and all that) in preparation for overnights, and bean bags (or any soft materials that can be used as a bed), should the coffee not perform as advertised. (It did not.)

Another anniversary issue put to bed, screaming, writhing and scratching like a toddler deprived of chocolate and cartoons. Bhaskar dislocated his shoulder, FatBeing went down with the flu, Vijay complained all throughout of an aching body, Sanket had to go visit his in-laws for a post-wedding ritual and everyone except Rossi and Nash complained about the 16-hour workdays. It always seems like a miracle, and it always gets done—don't ask us how. We just hope you enjoyed the results.

In other news, Samir (aka Shady, aka “You camping %^\$@”) has left our portals, leaving Michael a teary mess. We're always looking for new blood to spill (in *Quake III*, silly), so write in and apply for a job if you're interested. We will undoubtedly miss the entertainment and target practice Samir so generously provided to the whole team. From now on, we'll have to make do with fragging Michael to kingdom come. Hey, maybe that's why he's so teary-eyed to see Shady leave!

Vijay—miffed at the fact that he was recognised from a mile away due to the heaving swell of his belly—decided that it had gone on too long, and hit the gym. And the gym, as gyms can sometimes do, hit back. There was the strong temptation (on both sides) to part ways, but they stuck to it, and after many painful hours of negotiations, have reached a mutu-

ally beneficial arrangement. The swell has been demoted to protrusion, and Vijay's new theme song is “I feel good!” (Complete with screeches and sound effects). Nimish (FatBeing) was inspired, but only in a moment of weakness. “What use is a FatBeing,” it dawned on him, “without Fat?”

Nash has started to show his ugly side—keep him awake long enough, and he spews the foulest of humour—the kind that even B-grade Bollywood comedies would reject. Once he makes it past that stage (miraculously, with limbs still attached), he oscillates between grammar-nerd humour (the kind with big words we bet even he doesn't understand) and religious propaganda. In his 25th waking hour, he finally comes up with a killer...and promptly falls asleep halfway through. We're still waiting for him to wake up, so maybe we'll share that with you next month.

Raaabo, as usual, is rueing the day he took over the magazine—not only does he have much more work to do, he has to spend innumerable hours with the Suits listening to management jabber like “strategise”, “monetise”, “add value” and other such Big Words. Someone pointed out that if

he hadn't already gone bald, he would have by now. We're starting to wonder who he sees when he blows people up in *Quake III*. We have a medical team on standby. You never know...

FatBeing lost his status as “young-ish blood” (he's 25) towards the end of the month, when a young reader addressed him as “Dear Uncle Chandiramani”. You've no doubt read the letter earlier in this issue. He has since been the victim of comments like “I told you to shave off that beard” and “When Uncle talks, you must listen”, and many such crimes against humanity.



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iPod Touch Giveaway.

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